

PSALMS XCI.—XCIII.

the snare of the fowler, and from the pestilence of destruction.^a

4 With his pinions will he cover thee, and under his wings shalt thou find shelter: shield and buckler is his truth.

5 Thou shalt not be afraid of the terror of the night; nor of the arrow that flieth by day;

6 Nor of the pestilence that stalketh in darkness; nor of the deadly disease that wasteth at noonday.

7 There shall fall at thy side a thousand, and ten thousand at thy right hand; unto thee (however) shall it not come nigh.

8 Only with thy eyes shalt thou behold it, and see the recompense of the wicked.

9 Because thou hast (said),^b The LORD is my protection; the Most High hast thou made thy refuge:

10 No evil shall befall thee, nor shall any plague come nigh unto thy tent.

11 For his angels will he give charge concerning thee, to guard thee on all thy ways.

12 Upon (their) hands shall they bear thee, that thou mayest not dash against a stone thy foot.

13 Upon the fierce lion and asp shalt thou tread: thou shalt trample under foot the young lion and serpent.^c

14 Because he hath fixed his desire upon me, therefore will I release him: I will set him on high, because he knoweth my name.

15 He will call on me, and I will answer him: with him will I be in distress; I will deliver him, and grant him honour.

16 With length of days will I satisfy him, and I will let him see my salvation.

PSALM XCI.

1 ¶ A psalm or song for the sabbath day.

2 It is a good thing to give thanks unto the LORD, and to sing praises unto thy name, O Most High:

3 To tell in the morning of thy kindness, and of thy faithfulness in the nights,

4 Upon a ten-stringed instrument, and

^a Philippon renders צָרָה "wickedness;" metaphorical, "the plague of wickedness;" not the actual pestilence which is spoken of in v. 6.

^b Rashi, who supplies "said." Others take these as the words of the Psalmist, "Because thou, O LORD, art my refuge."

^c Elsewhere rendered "dragon," "monster," &c.

upon the psaltery; and with the sweet^d sound of the harp.

5 For thou hast caused me to rejoice, O LORD, through thy doing: because of the works of thy hands will I triumph.

6 How great are thy works, O LORD! exceedingly profound are thy thoughts.

7 A brutish man knoweth it not, and a fool cannot understand this.

8 When the wicked spring up like herbs, and when all the workers of wickedness do flourish: it is that they may be destroyed evermore.

9 But thou art exalted to eternity, O LORD!

10 For, lo, thy enemies, O LORD, for, lo, thy enemies shall perish: all the workers of wickedness shall be scattered.

11 But thou exaltest my horn like that of a reem: I am anointed with fresh oil.

12 And my eye looketh on (the punishment of) those that regard me with envy: of the evildoers that rise up against me my ears shall hear it.

13 The righteous shall spring up like the palm-tree: like a cedar in Lebanon shall he grow high.

14 Planted in the house of the LORD, in the courts of our God shall they spring up.

15 They shall still flourish in high old age; they shall be vigorous and covered with foliage;

16 To declare that the LORD is upright: he is my rock, and there is no faultiness in him.

PSALM XCIII.

1 ¶ The LORD reigneth, he is clothed with excellency; the LORD is clothed, he hath girded himself with strength: (therefore) also the world is firmly established, that it cannot be moved.

2 Firmly established is thy throne from the beginning: from everlasting art thou (God).

3 The rivers have lifted up, O LORD, the rivers have lifted up their voice; the rivers lift up their waves.

^d One opinion cited by Aben Ezra; another referred to by him would make *Higgayon* an instrument, perhaps a guitar. So also Philippon. But if we derive מְדִינָה from מָדָה "to meditate," the meaning would justly be the meditating, soothing, or sweet sound elicited from the strings of the harp. Hence, Mendelssohn, "waked to thinking by the harp."